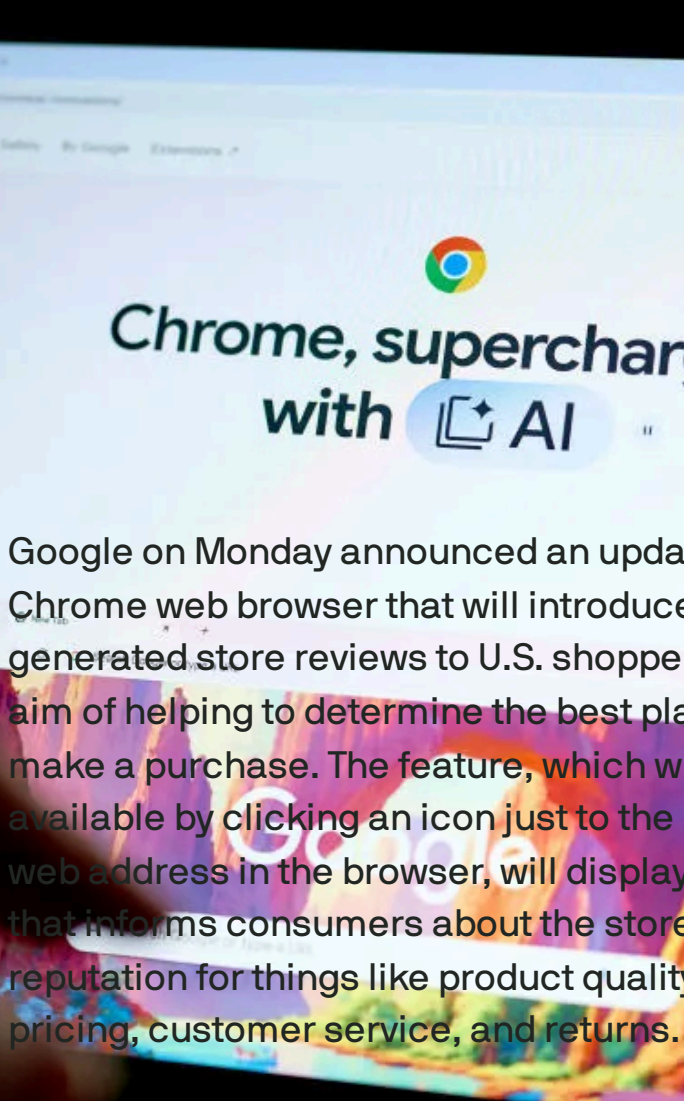


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COMMERCE



Google Chrome adds AI-powered store summaries to help US shoppers



Chrome, supercharged with AI

Google on Monday announced an update to its Chrome web browser that will introduce AI-generated store reviews to U.S. shoppers with the aim of helping to determine the best places to make a purchase. The feature, which will be available by clicking an icon just to the left of the web address in the browser, will display a pop-up that informs consumers about the store's reputation for things like product quality, shopping, pricing, customer service, and returns.

The feature, which is currently available only in English, will generate the summaries based on reviews from partners, including Bazaarvoice, Bizrate Insights, Reputation.com, Reseller Ratings, ScamAdviser, Trustpilot, TurnTo, Yotpo, Verified Reviews, [and others](#).

The feature will initially be available to Chrome on the desktop. When reached for comment, Google could not confirm if or when AI summaries would come to mobile devices.

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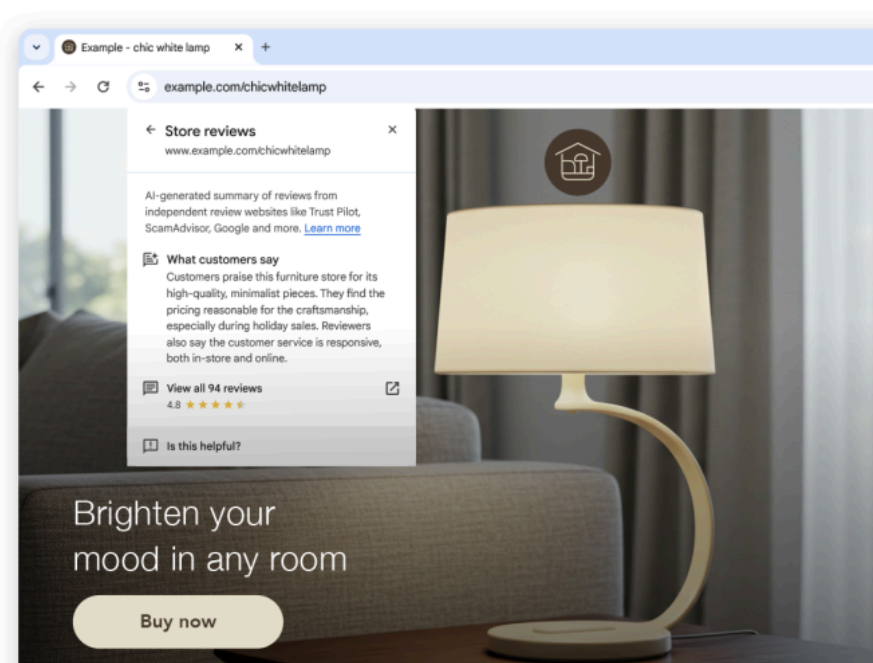


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Google says the goal with the summaries is to provide a safer and more efficient shopping experience. However, the feature also helps Google better compete with other AI features rolled out by retail giant Amazon, which has been using the new technology to [summarize product ratings and reviews](#), help customers [find clothes that fit](#), [get product recommendations and comparisons](#), and more.

The changes arrive as Google, for the first time in many years, is facing a potential competitive threat to Chrome’s dominance in the global browser market.

New AI-powered browsers like [Perplexity’s Comet](#), The Browser Company’s [Dia](#), [Opera Neon](#), and perhaps a [challenger from OpenAI](#) have the search giant thinking about how to infuse AI more directly into its own web browser. For example, Google is developing an AI agent that would be able [to take control of Chrome for you](#) to take actions on your behalf. Plus, the company recently [added support for its Gemini AI assistant in Chrome](#) for Gemini subscribers.

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren’t even dating apps

The move is also part of a broader initiative underway at Google to make it more of a modern-day shopping platform for consumers.

Already, the company has tapped AI to help customers [locate the products they're interested in](#), get personalized product recommendations, and [virtually try on clothes](#), and it has been [developing tools](#) for better price tracking, shopping in Google's AI Mode, and AI-powered agentic checkout. (The latter two were announced at this year's Google I/O developer conference. Google [recently announced](#) that getting outfit and room inspiration in AI Mode would roll out this fall.)

Topics: [AI](#) [Commerce](#) [Google](#) [shopping](#)



Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor |

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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AI



Microsoft's Bing Chat is coming to third-party browsers, including on mobile devices

Sarah Perez — 8:02 AM PDT · August 7, 2023

In late July, [Microsoft confirmed](#) its ChatGPT-like Bing Chat was testing in third-party browsers like Chrome and Safari for select users after various reports had spotted the feature in action. Today, the company directly announced that Bing Chat would “soon” be available in third-party browsers, including both on the web and on mobile devices.

IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT/OPENAI

The news indicates Microsoft aims to compete on AI across platforms besides its own, in addition to those places where Bing Chat is already available, like the Bing mobile app and Microsoft Edge web browser. It would also put the AI chatbot up against other browsers' built-in tools, like [Google's generative AI search features](#), available in the [Google mobile app and Chrome browser](#).

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During tests, for example, users [noticed](#) that Bing Chat in Chrome only supported five messages per conversation, instead of the 30 available in Microsoft Edge. It was also limiting the character count to 2,000, instead of the 3,000 supported by Edge.

Microsoft today hinted toward these limitations, adding that with Edge, users would “unlock longer conversations, chat history, and more Bing features built right into the browser.”

In the blog post, the company also celebrated several other recently launched features, including [multimodal visual search](#) in Bing Chat — meaning the ability to search using both text and images — a feature Google [first introduced back in 2021](#). Bing’s model, however, leverages Open AI to allow users to input images into the Chat and then prompt the chatbot with related questions.

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Microsoft additionally referenced the launch of Dark Mode for Bing Chat and the [newly announced Bing Chat Enterprise](#), which includes commercial data protection for use inside organizations where sensitive data cannot leak out. A number of businesses have already banned employees from using consumer applications like ChatGPT due to data protection requirements, including [Apple](#), [Samsung](#), [Walmart](#), [Verizon](#) and major [banks](#), including Bank of America, Citigroup, Deutsche Bank, Goldman Sachs, Wells Fargo, and [JPMorgan](#).

The company also revealed a few milestones about Bing Chat to date, noting that it's since seen over 1 billion chats and over 750 million images in the chatbot in addition to nine consecutive quarters of growth on Edge.

An exact launch date for third-party browser support for Bing Chat was not provided, but the feature is said to be arriving soon.

Microsoft’s Bing Chat comes to Chrome and Safari in tests for ‘select users’



Microsoft’s AI chatbot, Bing Chat, is coming to non-Microsoft browsers, the company confirmed today following various reports of the AI chatbot being spotted in other browsers like Google Chrome and Apple’s Safari. The expansion will make Microsoft’s ChatGPT-like AI chatbot available to a broader set of users, as it was previously available to consumers only ... Continue reading

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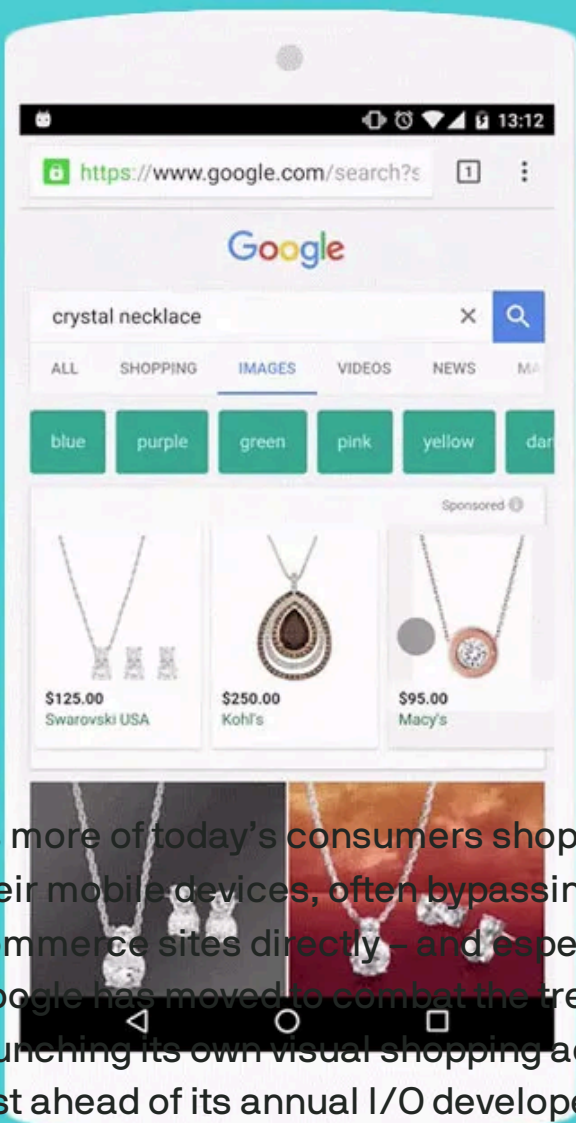
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Google Image Search will now include shopping ads

Sarah Perez — 7:00 AM PDT · May 17, 2016



As more of today's consumers shop online using their mobile devices, often bypassing Google for e-commerce sites directly – and especially Amazon – Google has moved to combat the trend by launching its own visual shopping ads. Announced just ahead of its annual I/O developer conference this week, Google unveiled Shopping ads on image search.

That means when shoppers are browsing through Google Image search results, they'll now see ads for related products, Google explained in an [announcement](#) on Monday. These ads appear at the top of the search results, above the images sourced from around the web.

Google's newer filter buttons can also be used with the ads, allowing customers to narrow down what they're looking for and then be directed to a retailer who sells them. The company says that many people who are browsing product images today have questions about the price of the item, or want to know where they can buy it.

With this launch, when a consumer now sees one of these image-based ads, they can click through and

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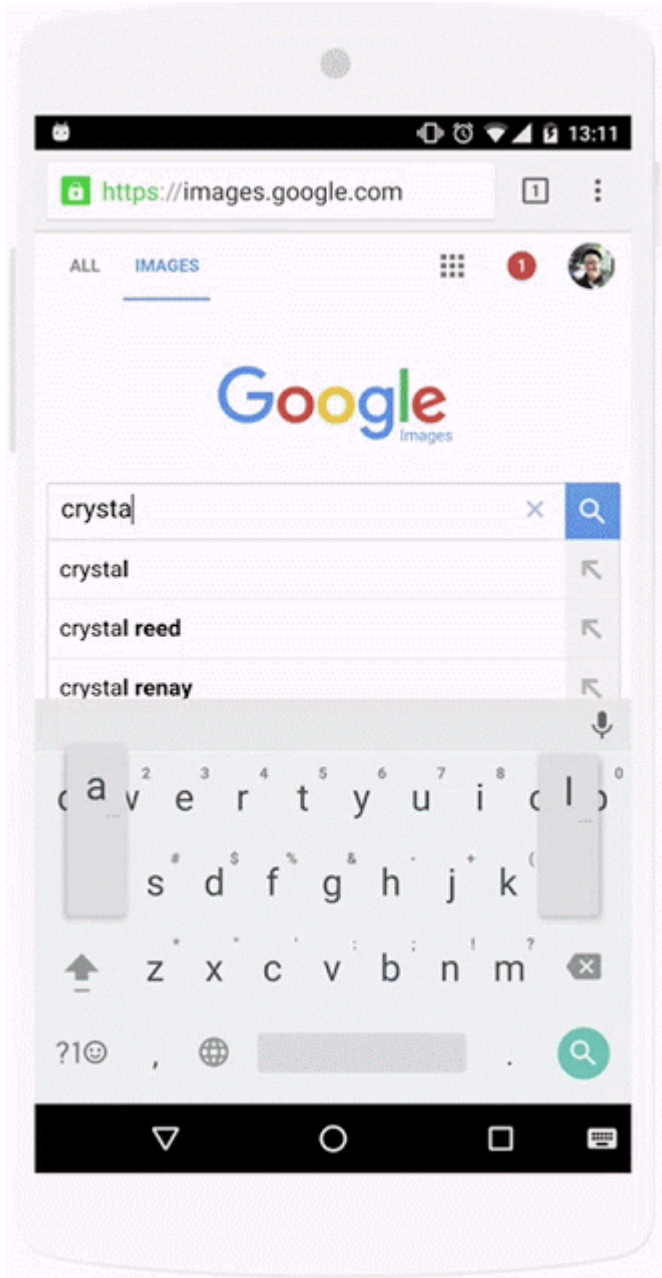
AI



Google denies AI search features are killing website traffic

Sarah Perez - 12 hours ago

have those questions answered – and they can buy the product immediately from the retailer’s website.



The company notes that people who search on smartphones at least once per week turn to product image ads as the shopping feature they use the most. What it didn’t say is how many of online shoppers are now skipping over Google entirely when they’re looking to buy. [A recent survey found that](#) 44 percent of shoppers go straight to Amazon versus just 34 percent who turn to search engines, and 21 percent who go to specific retailers’ websites.

Google says advertisers’ ads are automatically eligible to be displayed on Google Image Search as

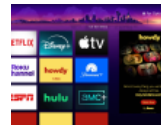
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part of the [Google Search Network](#). Swarovski is an early adopter of the new format, with plans to showcase its jewelry in Google Image Search.

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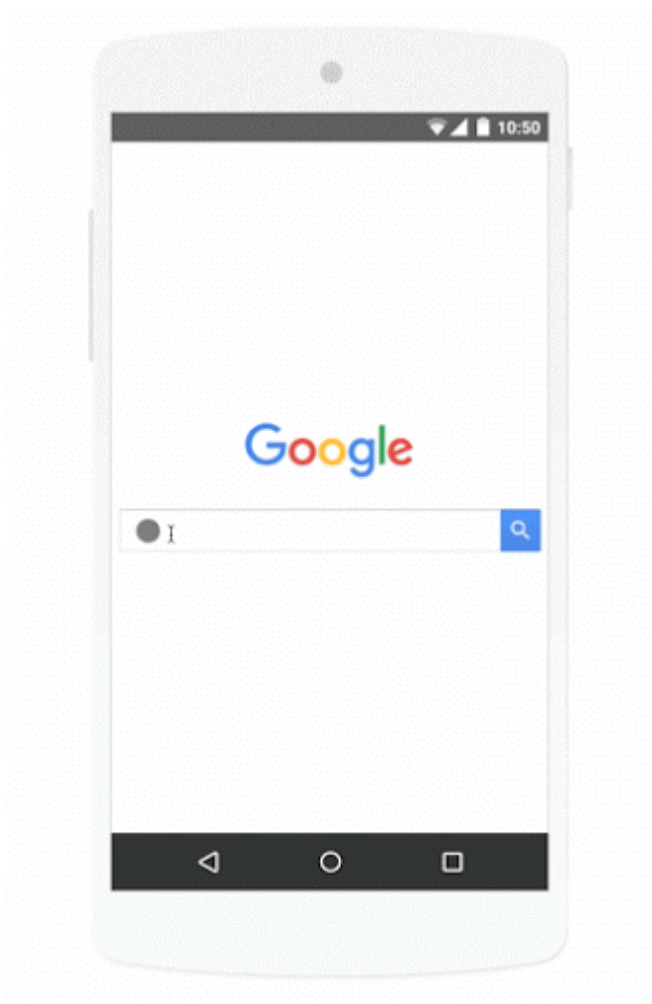
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While shopping ads in Image Search was one of the bigger announcements for online advertisers this week, it wasn't the only news related to mobile shopping. The company is also now allowing retailers to cater to the online shopping trend

where customers buy online, then pick up at their local store.



Starting this week, retailers can display if they offer this feature by adding a ‘store pickup link’ to their Google-hosted local product page. Kohl’s was using this feature during pilot testing, and reported a 40 to 50 percent increase in clicks, it said.

In addition, advertisers who use local inventory ads will now see their inventory searchable on Google.com in the local [Knowledge Panel](#) – this is the box that pops up with other information, like store hours and directions.

The company also offered a brief update on its same-day delivery service Google Express, though it didn’t speak about any hard numbers, like total revenues generated by participating retailers.

Instead, Google said that mobile accounted for over half of Google Express orders, that of Google

Express customers buying from participating merchants, over 50% are new to the merchant, and for existing customers of those merchants, they see sales growth of 18%.

Google says it's continuing to expand the service, and, with the addition of 23 million coming online next month in Texas, Google Express will reach over 120 million customers.

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